

A decorative border surrounds the central text box, featuring stylized green leaves, orange and yellow flowers, and blue bell-shaped flowers on thin stems.

Found Poetry from Famous Speeches

Found Poetry Assignment

Standards/ Objective

9-10W4: Create a poem, story, play, artwork, or other response to a text, author, theme or personal experience; demonstrate knowledge and understanding of a variety of techniques and genres. Explain divergences from the original when appropriate.

9-10R2: Determine one or more themes or central ideas in a text and analyze its development, including how it emerges and is shaped and refined by specific details; objectively and accurately summarize a text

Students will be able to determine a theme from a famous speech and create a found poem centered around that theme.

Assignment Details

In this assignment, students will be able to choose a famous speech and create a found poem using words from their chosen speech.

- Students will be given the option between 3 different famous speeches that discuss equality. “I have a Dream” by Martin Luther King Jr., “HeForShe: Gender Equality is Your Issue Too” by Emma Watson, and “On Women’s Right to Vote” by Susan B. Anthony.

*An extension to this assignment would be to have student display their poems around the classroom and have student take part in a gallery walk finding the themes in their peers poems.

Found Poetry Assignment instructions

1.

Students will be given instructions on what found poetry is and be shown an example.

2.

Instruct students to first read the speech they chose to get the gist of it. Then, the second time they read it have them look for themes and highlight potential words or phrases that they want to use in their poem.

3.

Using a separate sheet of paper or a Google Doc, students will create their poem using only words from the speech they selected. This poem needs to relate to the theme of the original speech. After constructing their poem, students will create a title.

Debate Assignment Analysis

Strengths

- Students have the opportunity to read and understand a speech about equality
- Students are able to show creativity

Weaknesses

1. Some of the speeches selected are long.
2. Students may become overwhelmed by the assignment

Remedies to the Weaknesses

1. Some of the speeches are longer, for this students can listen to the speech while reading it.
2. For some, writing poetry can be a daunting task. To help with this, you can break the task down into smaller parts and even give them starting points. Since this is a free-verse poem they are able to have a lot of creative freedom.

